

SCHOOL REPORTER BUSINESS CASE

Project Name: School Reporter

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Executive Summary

The School Reporter project proposes the implementation of a digital platform that improves communication between schools and parents while streamlining key administrative processes. The solution enables teachers to manage learner attendance, homework, behaviour records and school announcements through a centralised system.

Many schools continue to rely on paper-based records and fragmented communication methods, making it difficult to provide parents with timely updates regarding their children's academic progress. The School Reporter platform addresses these challenges by digitising school administration and improving access to learner information.

This business case demonstrates the need for the project, evaluates available options, estimates implementation costs and expected benefits, and recommends proceeding with the proposed solution.

1. Business Need

Many schools continue to rely on manual administrative processes, including paper attendance registers, homework diaries and printed notices for parent communication.

These processes are time-consuming, susceptible to human error and often delay communication between schools and parents.

The absence of a centralised digital platform also limits visibility into learner progress and increases the administrative burden placed on teachers.

To improve operational efficiency and strengthen collaboration between schools and parents, a modern digital solution is required.

2. Problem Statement

Schools require a secure and centralised system that enables teachers to manage learner information digitally while improving communication with parents through timely access to attendance records, homework, learner behaviour and school announcements.

3. Proposed Solution

Develop the **School Reporter** platform to provide a secure, web-based solution for managing school administration and communication.

The proposed system will include:

- Secure teacher authentication
- School selection
- Learner management
- Class management
- Attendance management
- Homework management
- Behaviour management
- Parent notifications
- Reporting and analytics
- User administration
- POPIA-compliant security controls

4. Business Objectives

The project aims to:

- Improve communication between schools and parents.
- Digitise manual school administration processes.
- Improve the accuracy of learner records.
- Reduce administrative workload for teachers.
- Improve operational efficiency.
- Support better decision-making through reporting and analytics.
- Improve accountability through digital record management.

5. Options Considered

Options	Description	Recommendation
Option 1	Continue using existing manual processes	Not Recommended
Option 2	Purchase an existing commercial school management system	Considered but may not fully meet the school's requirements and may involve recurring licensing costs.
Option 3	Develop the School Reporter platform	Recommended

6. Estimated Project Costs

The following estimates represent the projected costs for developing and implementing the School Reporter platform.

Cost Category	Estimated Cost (ZAR)
Business Analysis	R45,000
UI/UX Design	R35,000

Software Development	R380,000
Database Development	R70,000
Testing & Quality Assurance	R60,000
Cloud Hosting (Year 1)	R36,000
Security & POPIA Compliance	R45,000
User Training	R30,000
Project Management	R80,000
Contingency (10%)	R78,000
Total Estimated Investment	R859,000

7. Expected Benefits

Financial Benefits

Benefit	Estimated Annual Saving
Reduced printing and stationery	R45,000
Reduced administrative workload	R180,000
Improved teacher productivity	R120,000
Reduced manual reporting	R65,000
Improved record accuracy	R40,000

Total Annual Benefit R450,000

Non-Financial Benefits

The project is also expected to provide significant qualitative benefits, including:

- Improved communication between schools and parents.
- Increased parental engagement.
- Better learner accountability.
- Faster access to learner information.
- Improved reporting capabilities.
- Improved compliance with POPIA.
- Enhanced school reputation through digital transformation.

8. Cost–Benefit Analysis

Item	Value
Initial Investment	R859,000
Estimated Annual Benefits	R450,000
Estimated Payback Period	Approximately 23 months
Estimated Five-Year Benefits	R2,250,000
Estimated Net Benefit	R1,391,000
Estimated Return on Investment (ROI)	162%

The projected financial benefits indicate that the investment is expected to recover its implementation costs within approximately two years while delivering long-term operational savings.

9. Risks

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
User resistance to change	Medium	Provide training and user support.
Data privacy breaches	High	Implement secure authentication and POPIA controls.
Scope changes	Medium	Manage changes through formal requirements management.
Technical issues	Medium	Perform comprehensive testing before deployment.
Internet connectivity	Medium	Design the solution to minimise downtime and support reliable hosting.

10. Assumptions

The following assumptions have been made:

- Schools have reliable internet connectivity.
- Teachers have access to computers or tablets.
- Parents have access to smartphones capable of receiving notifications.
- School management supports the implementation of digital processes.
- Users will receive basic system training before implementation.

11. Constraints

The project is subject to the following constraints:

- Budget limitations.
- Project delivery timelines.
- Compliance with POPIA.
- Availability of technical resources.

- Dependence on reliable internet connectivity.

12. Success Measures

The project will be considered successful if:

- Teachers can successfully manage learner information digitally.
- Administrative workload is reduced.
- Parents receive timely updates.
- School communication improves.
- Reporting supports informed decision-making.
- The solution complies with POPIA requirements.
- Stakeholders approve the delivered solution.

13. Future Enhancements

The School Reporter platform may be expanded in future releases to include:

- A dedicated mobile application for parents.
- Push notifications for learner attendance, homework and behaviour updates.
- Academic performance dashboards.
- Two-way messaging between teachers and parents.
- Calendar integration for school events.
- Parent submission of learner absence requests.
- Integration with additional school management systems.

14. Recommendation

Based on the estimated implementation costs, projected financial return and expected operational improvements, it is recommended that the School Reporter project proceed.

The proposed solution addresses the identified business challenges by improving school administration, enhancing communication with parents and providing a secure,

centralised platform for managing learner information. With an estimated return on investment of **162%** over five years and a projected payback period of approximately **23 months**, the project presents a strong business case for implementation.

Document Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
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